Lesson Plan Day 1: Introduce Students to YAWP!

In this lesson, students will be introduced to the YAWP! assignment and create their YAWP! accounts.

STUDENTS WILL…

- Understand the purpose and philosophy of the YAWP! assignment
- Read a sample essay
- Create their YAWP! accounts and join your class

TEACHER WILL…

- Explain YAWP!
- Facilitate brief discussion on sample essay
- Lead students through joining your class on YAWP!

MATERIALS NEEDED

Slide deck · Sample essay (“Bored in the USA”) · Student laptops/chromebooks and access to yawp.school · Before class: your class set up in YAWP!, with the Thesis-Driven Essay assigned

Instructions

1. Open with the game **“2 Truths and a Lie.”** This is designed to simply engage students in a fun way at the top of the program.

   SLIDES 2-5

   a. The two reveal slides are Brian’s own. Make your own version, with two photos of yourself and your own two truths and a lie, using his as the model. Or delete them.

      SLIDES 3-4

2. **Define YAWP!**

   a. Using Walt Whitman’s quote, define the term “yawp” for the students.

      SLIDES 6-7

   b. Using the slides, discuss why we write. This creates shared context and understanding of “What’s the point of this?”

      SLIDE 8

3. **Read Sample Essay.** Don’t overanalyze or get in the weeds here. Let students connect to it and then help them find the thesis statement.

   SLIDES 9-10

   a. Show the Critical Essay Form and what the class is here to do: write a thoughtful, original, critical essay.

      SLIDES 11-12

4. **Onboard students to yawp.school.** The website is simply “yawp.school”: there is no “www” or

".com."

a. Open your class in YAWP! and go to its **Students** tab. Share the **join link**, or put its QR code up on the board. (The class code shown there is for your reference; it isn't enough to join.)

   `SLIDE 13`

b. Students open the link on their device, choose a display name, a handle and a password, and click **Join class.** No email needed. The Student Sign-up handout walks them through it.

   `SLIDE 14`

c. Keep a note of handles and passwords, or give the class a pattern to follow, to avoid the inevitable forgotten passwords. You can reset a student's password from the Students tab.

d. Once they're in, have students open the class from their dashboard and start the Thesis-Driven Essay, which creates their document. Next class they open the same document (not a new one) and begin pre-writing.

   `SLIDE 15`

Adapted from Brian Connell's lesson plan for the YAWP! Writing Program, with slide numbers for the new deck. Step 4 is updated for today's join flow; the old plan's "Welcome to YAWP!" course and Welcome Exercise are retired.